

## **The Third Level**

### **Character Sketch of Charley**

Charlie was a nervous person. His hobby was collecting stamps. He was a young man, yet he was afraid to live in the violent society. He desired to visit a peaceful and idyllic place. Charley is an optimist who constantly sees the positive aspects of situations. He regularly expresses his desire to escape the ordinary reality of his daily existence and is also a dreamer. His fascination with time travel has led him to think that the Third Level of Grand Central Station serves as a gateway to the past. Charley is an adventurous person who welcomes a challenge. Sam is reluctant at first, but Charley persuades him to go with him to explore the Third Level.

### **Character Sketch of Louisa**

Louisa is a practical, level-headed, and rational person. Louisa helps her husband stay grounded by reminding him of his responsibilities in the outside world. She is also portrayed as being a loving and understanding wife to her anxious husband. Louisa first has doubts about the Third Level and believes it is just a figment of her husband's imagination. She hears him out, makes an effort to comprehend his anxieties, and implores him to get help from a professional. She is kind to him and encourages him as he makes baby strides towards recovery.

### **Character Sketch of Sam**

Sam was a psychiatrist. He was Charley's friend as well. Sam is a practical and sensible individual who enjoys his life. He retains his composure and is resistant to Charley's imaginative ideas. However, out of curiosity and a desire to disprove Charley, Sam ultimately decides to go with him.

He spoke with several psychic patients every day, who shared their problems and fears with him. Sam's life has become burdened as a result of this. He also began looking for a sojourn. After hearing about the suffering of those with mental illnesses, he yearned to leave the miserable life he had come to lead. Sam prevents himself from enjoying the full potential of life by his reluctance to take chances and investigate new ideas.

## **The Tiger King**

### **Character Sketch of Tiger King**

The Maharaja of Pratibandapuram, Sir Jilani Jung Jung Bahadur, had many titles and sub-names. However, he was popular as the Tiger King. When he was born, the astrologers had predicted his death which would be caused by a tiger. But the baby had some miraculous

quality in him. He was only ten days old, when he challenged the prediction of the astrologers and asked them the manner of his death. The Chief astrologers foretold that he was born in the hour of the Bull. The Bull and the Tiger are enemies. Therefore his death would come from the Tiger.

The Crown Prince was brought up in an English environment. He grew up a tall, sturdy, brave and strong man. He became the king of his state at the age of twenty. He was determined to fulfill his pledge. So he issued a proclamation not to kill the tigers except by himself. Being a man of firm determination and self-respect, he denied permission to the British officer to hunt a tiger. In return, he had to pay a high price to retain his throne. In a duration of ten years, he killed seventy tigers and his forests became extinct. Then he married a princess whose father had a large forest cover full of tigers. There he killed more and reached ninety-nine tigers but the hundredth one merely fainted due to the shock of the bullet. His hunters came there and killed it. Thus the tiger king thought that he had fulfilled his vow. Thus it can be said that he was a brave, courageous king but lacked worldly wisdom.

### **Character Sketch of Durai**

Durai was a high ranking British officer. He was fond of hunting tigers but his wish was declined by the king. He then requested for getting a photograph with a tiger killed by maharaja and this request of his was also rejected.

### **Character Sketch of Duraisani**

The 'Duraisani' was the wife of a high-ranking British officer who visited Pratibandapuram. She had a lot of influence on her husband. The Tiger King used her to avoid his kingdom being confiscated by the British officer in response to being refused to do tiger hunting in his kingdom. The Tiger King sent fifty diamond rings as bribe to Duraisani expecting her to keep one or two out of them and send the rest back. However, the 'Duraisani' turned out to be very greedy; she kept all the fifty rings and sent a 'thank you' note to the king.

### **Character Sketch of Chief Astrologer**

The Chief Astrologer is an important character in the story as he is the one who predicts the Tiger King's fate. He is also superstitious and believes in the power of astrology and prophecy. He vows to burn his books and cut off his tuft in case his prediction turned wrong.

### **Journey to the end of the world**

### **Character sketch of Tishani Doshi**

Tishani Doshi is characterised as a young, beautiful, and adventurous woman who is full of energy and enthusiasm. She also has a cheerful, outgoing personality which makes her connect with people. Tishani was quite enthusiastic about travelling to Antarctica. She is excited to find out more about the distinct ecosystem and species there and sees it as an opportunity to travel to a new and distant region of the world. Tishani is also very concerned about climate change, and she wants to use her poems to spread awareness of how our actions affect the environment. While travelling to Antarctica, she encounters a number of challenges. She finds it challenging to cope with the great cold and tough surroundings, as well as the seasickness she experienced on the rough journey to the continent. However, she was resilient and determined, and she pushes through these challenges to fully experience the trip.

## **The Enemy**

### **Character Sketch of Dr Sadao Hoki**

Sadao Hoki was a Japanese doctor who had been educated in the United States and was renowned for his surgical skills. Dr. Sadao is a man of great intelligence and resourcefulness, who is torn between his loyalty to his country and his humanistic values. Ultimately, he chooses to follow his conscience and do what he believes is right, even if it means going against the interests of his country. Sadao is wholly responsible for saving the life of Tom, an American prisoner of war who washes up on the beach alongside Sadao and Hana's isolated home on the Japanese coast. He risks his own life and that of his family to nurse the soldier back to health. Despite the fact that the soldier is a threat to his country, Dr. Sadao believes that it is his duty to save the life of a fellow human being. He knows that if he hands over the soldier to the authorities, he will be killed. Therefore, he takes a calculated risk and decides to smuggle the soldier out of the country.

### **Character Sketch of Hana**

Hana is the wife of Dr. Sadao Hoki, the protagonist of the story "The Enemy" by Pearl S. Buck. She is a skilled nurse and a supportive partner to her husband. Here are some of her key characteristics:

**Supportive:** Hana is a supportive wife who stands by her husband, Dr. Sadao Hoki, in his decision to help the American prisoner of war, even though it puts their lives at risk. She provides emotional support to him and helps him navigate the moral dilemma he faces.

**Skilled Nurse:** Hana is a skilled nurse who assists her husband in his medical practice. She is knowledgeable about medicine and helps Dr. Hoki in treating the wounded enemy soldier.

**Compassionate:** Like her husband, Hana is a compassionate person who feels empathy for the suffering of others, regardless of their nationality. She agrees to help the wounded American soldier because she believes it is the right thing to do.

Conflicted: Hana is also conflicted about her husband's decision to help the enemy soldier, knowing that it puts them both at risk. She struggles to reconcile her loyalty to her country with her moral duty to help the wounded soldier.

Strong-willed: Hana is a strong-willed character who is not afraid to speak her mind. She voices her opinion to her husband about his decision to help the enemy soldier and supports him even when he faces opposition from his staff.

Overall, Hana is a compassionate, supportive, and strong-willed character who plays a crucial role in helping Dr. Sadao Hoki make the difficult decision to help the wounded American soldier.

Hana is an epitome of a loving, dedicated and caring wife. She always has love and affection in her heart for Sadao. In spite of being married for so many years, she is still the same loving wife. She assists Sadao in the medical operations and the anesthetics while operating Tom. She loves her family. She gets scared when a man in uniform appears at the gate. She is also a good-hearted woman as she also wished Tom to be saved. She is quite hardworking. When Yumi, the nurse refuses to wash Tom, she does it herself. When the servants leave Sadao's home in protest, she does all the chores herself. However, she is not as courageous as Sadao.

### **Character Sketch of Yumi**

Yumi was the caretaker of Sadao and Hana's children. She largely tends to the children and is seen with them far more than Hana herself is. She is one of the servants at Dr. Sadao Hoki and Hana's house. She was quite a patriotic woman. Like the gardener, she is openly prejudiced against Tom and speaks critically of Sadao and Hana for saving a white man. She is so frightened by Sadao and Hana's lawbreaking and shocking empathy for the enemy that she stubbornly refuses to follow orders, refuses to wash Tom and eventually leaves the household altogether with the gardener and the cook. When Sadao did not hand over the POW to the police in spite of the servants' protests, she also decided to leave Sadao's house. She took this decision quite unwillingly. She was quite attached to the kids. Her tear-soaked departure comes as an emotional blow for her (who is in charge of the servants) and for Yumi herself, because Yumi cares for the two children as if they are her own. She is distraught at the thought of what would happen to the children if their father was found out as a "traitor." However, when POW went away, she along with the other servants rejoined their duties at Sadao's house. However, Yumi insists on burning Sulphur in the guest room, where Tom had been staying, "to get the white man's smell out of it."

### **Character Sketch of American Soldier Tom**

Tom is a young American prisoner of war who was captured and tortured by the Japanese but somehow escaped. He washes up on the beach near Dr. Sadao Hoki and Hana's isolated house, and they discern that he's a prisoner of war, from his recent bullet wound (reopened by one of the rocks out at sea), his blonde hair, and his U.S. navy cap. Even though Tom is unconscious or sleeping for much of his time, his mere presence forces them to grapple with their conflicting impulses to help a fellow human or to be loyal to one's country. When he is conscious, Tom is scared of Sadao but also deeply grateful to the surgeon for saving his life—praises him which Sadao coldly shrugs off. After saving Tom's life through surgery, Sadao knows that he can't

allow the American to stay, but nor can he turn the American over to the authorities—the boy will surely die a torturous death. Sadao arranges for the General, an influential patient of his, to have a few assassins come to Sadao's house in the middle of the night to silently kill Tom and do away with his body. When the assassins fail to show up night after night, Sadao decides to take matters into his own hands by helping Tom escape by boat to a nearby island, where he's bound to be saved by a Korean fishing boat. The plan works, and Sadao is ultimately baffled as to why he couldn't just kill Tom, given that Americans are his enemies and he hates all white people. In the story, Tom is the catalyst for human kindness, forcing Sadao and Hana to consider the universality of humankind and the inherent human impulse to be kind.

### **Character Sketch of General Takima**

General Takima is a high-ranking military officer in Japan during World War II. He is the head of the army and is respected and feared by those under his command. General Takima is depicted as a strict and uncompromising leader who is unwavering in his loyalty to his country and its emperor.

He is characterized by his strong sense of duty and loyalty to Japan, which often leads him to take harsh measures to ensure that his subordinates follow orders. He is also portrayed as a traditionalist who believes in the honor and glory of the Japanese military.

General Takima is deeply suspicious of the Americans and sees them as a threat to Japan's sovereignty. He is opposed to Dr. Sadao's decision to help the American prisoner of war and is willing to risk the lives of innocent civilians to capture him.

Throughout the story, General Takima is presented as a formidable and intimidating figure who is willing to do whatever it takes to defend his country. However, his character also reveals a certain vulnerability, particularly when he is confronted with the humanity of the enemy soldier and the moral dilemma it presents.

Overall, General Takima's character represents the strict and traditionalist values of the Japanese military during the war, and his interactions with Dr. Sadao highlight the conflict between duty to country and personal morality.

### **On face of it**

### **Character Sketch of Derry**

Derry is a 14-year-old boy who suffers from a sense of inferiority complex. It was because he was physically disabled due to a terrible accident in his childhood. As a result, he has a scarred face and is blind in one eye. This makes him lonely and withdrawn. He avoids the company of others. He thinks that people get scared when they look at his horrible face. So he keeps himself away from others. But his meeting with Lamb brings a turning point in his life. It gives him confidence. He is able to develop a positive attitude towards life.

Overall, Derry is a thoughtful and kind person who is able to see the beauty in the world despite his difficult circumstances.

### **Character Sketch of Mr. Lamb**

Mr. Lamb is an elderly man who has a tin leg. Children called him Lamey- Lamb. He lived alone and kept the doors of his garden open which symbolises his openmindedness towards all who

visited his garden. He becomes happy by spending time with others and reading books. He knows the art of living. He is a man with a positive attitude.

He brought a major change in Derry's attitude towards life as he was full of negativity due to the scar on his face. Mr. Lamb told him to meet people happily and learn to be happy with himself instead of burning himself with the acid of hatred for others. He demonstrates the power of kindness and empathy, and he serves as a role model for both Derry and the reader.

#### **Character Sketch of Derry's Mom**

Derry's mother is overprotective and doesn't understand her son's longing for companionship. She does not allow him to meet Mr. Lamb. She treats Derry with a sense of pity and robs him of his dignity by perpetually treating him like a helpless victim.

#### **Memories of the childhood**

##### **Character Sketch of Zitkala Sa**

The author Zitkala Sa, was a native American who was a victim of racism in the Carlisle Indian school at a young age. She faced indignity, discrimination and exploitation at school. She is caught in dogma because of the strict regulations imposed on her. In spite of this, she is quite determined/optimistic to fight against the pale face women. She was forced to get her hair shingled against which she protested to the best of her capacity though she didn't succeed. She is symbolic of all the native American women who were exploited at the hands of their masters. She suffered extreme indignities and felt humiliated. She is very sensitive because at last, she comments that she is now one among the many animals driven by the herders.

##### **Character Sketch of Bama**

Bama is a small innocent school girl of South India and is a victim of caste discrimination and untouchability. She is always curious and pondered about various things- the way in which the tea stall owners poured the tea etc. She is a typical kid who is very observant and gets distracted because of all the fun and entertaining events happening around her. She is surprised to see distinction based on class and caste. When her brother tells her about the reality, she was astonished to realize the fact that the rich and upper caste people have lost all humanity. She feels that they too are human beings. Her brother who tells her about the mishap in their life because they are born into this community. The words of her brother that until their Dalit community can uplift their identity through education they will continue to be looked down upon makes a deep impact on her mind. She becomes studious and studies hard to stand first in her class to overcome the discrimination done with the backward class people. In this way, she wins everyone's respect and becomes a role model for all Dalits.

##### **Character Sketch of Annan**

Bama's elder brother, Annan, was a university Student. He came home for the holidays. He told Bama that they were born into the community of untouchables and were never given honour, respect, recognition and dignity. Annan told Bama that until their Dalit community would uplift their identity through education, they will continue to be looked down upon and run roughshod over. He encourages Bama to use the opportunities offered by

education to elude the odds of caste discrimination and bridge the chasm of racial inequality. His words leave a deep imprint on the mind and soul of little Bama.